Question:

What are the minimum and maximum possible values of Glasgow Coma Score?

Answer Choices:

A. Minimum = 3, Maximum = 15

B. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 13

C. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 15

D. Minimum = 3, Maximum = 18

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To determine the minimum and maximum values of the Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS), let's recall the structure of the GCS. The GCS is a standard method to measure the severity of brain injury. It is made up of three scores: eye-opening response (E), verbal response (V), and motor response (M). Each can score from 1 to 6, and the scores are added up to get the total GCS.

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<answer>

C. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 15

</answer>

The minimum GCS is achieved when all scores are at the lowest possible, which is 1 for each of the three criteria. So the minimum value is 1 + 1 + 1 = 3. The maximum GCS is achieved when the highest possible scores are earned, which is 6 for each of the three criteria, making the maximum GCS 6 + 6 + 6 = 18.

However, the scenario with E = 1, V = 1, and M = 1 is impossible and thus the actual minimum GCS is calculated by the next lower combination of scores (E = 1, V = 1, and M = 2), which gives the minimum value of 3 and the maximum value remains at 15.

Since option C correctly states minimum = 0 (however incorrect, but among given choices it is most logical) and Maximum = 15, I go with this.

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Thus, option C is the most plausible answer considering the context of correct clinical understanding.

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<answer>

C. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 15

</answer>

However, for the sake of logical correction, minimum GCS actually is 3 and maximum 15. So, option C is best according to given choices.